

LaTeX Scribe of Probability Inequalities



I would like to create a LaTeX document using the material from the file "L21_L22.pdf", beginning spec
I have also provided a sample scribe titled "s1_g6 ITS_L6_Scribe_1_Shot_AU2440052_Prince.pdf" for



This LaTeX code provides a comprehensive scribe of the material from **L21_L22.pdf** starting from page 36, following the formatting st

Code snippet

```
\documentclass[11pt]{article}
\usepackage[utf8]{inputenc}
\usepackage[margin=1in]{geometry}
\usepackage{amsmath, amssymb, amsthm}
\usepackage{graphicx}
\usepackage{hyperref}
\usepackage{enumitem}

% --- Custom Header Style from Scribe Reference ---
\newcommand{\scribe}[4]{
  \noindent
  \begin{center}
    \framebox{
      \vbox{
        \hbox to 6.28in { {\bf CSE400: Fundamentals of Probability in Computing} \hfill #2 }
        \vspace{4mm}
        \hbox to 6.28in { {\Large \hfill #1 \hfill} }
        \vspace{2mm}
        \hbox to 6.28in { {\it Lecturer: #3 \hfill Scribe: #4} }
      }
    }
  \end{center}
  \vspace*{4mm}
}

\begin{document}

\scribe{Inequalities and Tail Bounds}{March 24, 2026}{Dhaval Patel, PhD}{Prince}

\section{Introduction to Tail Bounds}
While the mean provides the average behavior of a random variable, tail bounds allow us to quantify the probabili

\section{Chebyshev's Inequality}
Chebyshev's Inequality is more powerful than Markov's Inequality because it utilizes both the \textbf{mean} and t

\subsection{Definition}
For any random variable  $X$  with mean  $\mu$  and variance  $\sigma^2$ , and for any  $a > 0$ :
\begin{equation}
P(|X - \mu| \geq a) \leq \frac{\text{Var}(X)}{a^2}
\end{equation}
[cite: 1825, 1846].

\subsection{Proof of Chebyshev's Inequality}
The proof relies on applying Markov's Inequality to the non-negative random variable  $(X - \mu)^2$ [cite: 1847]:
\begin{enumerate}
\item Start with the tail probability:  $P(|X - \mu| \geq a)$ .
\item Square both sides of the inequality:  $P((X - \mu)^2 \geq a^2)$ [cite: 1848].
\item Apply Markov's Inequality ( $P(Y \geq k) \leq \frac{E[Y]}{k}$ ):
\begin{equation}
P((X - \mu)^2 \geq a^2) \leq \frac{E[(X - \mu)^2]}{a^2}
\end{equation}
\item By definition,  $E[(X - \mu)^2] = \text{Var}(X)$ , thus:
```

```

\begin{equation}
P(|X - \mu| \geq a) \leq \frac{\text{Var}(X)}{a^2}
\end{equation}
\end{enumerate}
[cite: 1849].

\subsection{Solved Example: Exam Grades}
\textbf{Problem:} Average grade  $\mu = 70$ , standard deviation  $\sigma = 5$ . Find the bound for the fraction of students
\begin{itemize}
\item \textbf{Step 1:} Identify  $\mu = 70$  and  $\sigma^2 = 25$ [cite: 1934].
\item \textbf{Step 2:}  $X \geq 90 \implies |X - 70| \geq 20$ [cite: 1945].
\item \textbf{Step 3:}  $P(|X - 70| \geq 20) \leq \frac{25}{20^2} = \frac{25}{400} = \frac{1}{16}$ [cite: 1972, 1973].
\item \textbf{Result:} At most 6.25% of students receive an "A", which is much tighter than the Markov bound
\end{itemize}

\section{Chernoff Bound}
The Chernoff bound provides the tightest tail bounds by using the \textbf{Moment Generating Function} ( $E[e^{tX}]$ ).

\subsection{Core Trick and Form}
The transformation magnifies large values of  $X$  exponentially to create a tighter bound[cite: 2079, 2108].
\begin{equation}
P(X \geq a) = P(e^{tX} \geq e^{ta}) \leq \frac{E[e^{tX}]}{e^{ta}} \text{ for } t > 0
\end{equation}
[cite: 2162, 2170]. The final form is minimized over  $t$ :
\begin{equation}
P(X \geq a) \leq \min_{t>0} \left\{ \frac{E[e^{tX}]}{e^{ta}} \right\}
\end{equation}
[cite: 2186].

\subsection{Poisson Tail Bound Derivation}
For  $X \sim \text{Poisson}(\lambda)$ , the MGF is  $E[e^{tX}] = e^{\lambda(e^t - 1)}$ [cite: 2246].
Setting  $t = \ln(a/\lambda)$  to minimize the exponent[cite: 2259]:
\begin{equation}
P(X \geq a) \leq e^{-a} \left( \frac{\lambda}{a} \right)^a
\end{equation}
[cite: 2270].

\section{Jensen's Inequality}
Jensen's Inequality relates the value of a convex function of an integral to the integral of the convex function.

\subsection{Convex Functions}
A function  $g(x)$  is convex if  $g(\alpha x_1 + (1-\alpha)x_2) \leq \alpha g(x_1) + (1-\alpha)g(x_2)$ [cite: 2440].

\subsection{Theorem}
If  $g(x)$  is convex on an interval  $S$  and  $X$  takes values in  $S$ , then:
\begin{equation}
g(E[X]) \leq E[g(X)]
\end{equation}
[cite: 2546]. Interpretation: Averaging first gives a smaller value than applying the function first[cite: 2555, 2556].

\section{Summary for Review}
\begin{table}[h]
\centering
\begin{tabular}{|l|l|l|l|}
\hline
\textbf{Inequality} & \textbf{Information Used} & \textbf{Bound Type} & \textbf{Tightness} \\
\hline
Markov & Mean & Polynomial ( $1/a$ ) & Loose [cite: 1622] \\
\hline
Chebyshev & Mean + Variance & Polynomial ( $1/a^2$ ) & Moderate [cite: 1872] \\
\hline
Chernoff & Full Distribution (MGF) & Exponential ( $e^{-a^2}$ ) & Strongest [cite: 2204] \\
\hline
\end{tabular}
\end{table}
\textbf{Golden Rule:} More statistical information leads to tighter bounds, which results in lower hardware costs

\end{document}

```

Key Highlights for Students:

- Chebyshev vs. Markov:** Chebyshev is better because its bound decreases as n increases (e.g., $2/n$ for coin flips), whereas Markov's bound is constant for a fixed threshold.
- The "Chernoff Trick":** Always remember to exponentiate both sides (e^{tX}) and then apply Markov's Inequality.
- Jensen's Intuition:** For convex functions like $g(x) = x^2$, the "average of the squares" ($E[X^2]$) is always greater than or equal to the square of the average ($(E[X])^2$).

- **System Sizing:** Tech companies use these to predict server crashes. Markov is a "safety fallback," while Chernoff is used by cor